The Indus, that flowed through Ladakh, was extremely important for the survival of the people of Pakistan. The corollary of Operation Datta Khel was that the takeover of the Gilgit Agency would provide Pakistan a means to outflank India in the race for Ladakh and the waters of the Indus.

Only a week after the memorandum of 25 October 1947 was sent to Attlee, Mountbatten and Ismay flew to Lahore to discuss the Kashmir crisis with Jinnah and Liaquat Ali Khan.[9] This summit was inconclusive. Ismay was put in the uncomfortable position of opposing the party line of the British deep state. Liaquat Ali Khan visited New Delhi in December 1947 and Mountbatten, Nehru, Baldev Singh and Ayyangar followed him to Lahore. For a plebiscite to happen, Pakistan needed the Indian Army to withdraw and then have a 'neutral' caretaker government to replace the Mahajan-Abdullah diarchy. By now, post-Operation Datta Khel, the Government of India was convinced that the Pakistani Government had officially sponsored both the operations. During the last two months of 1947, the Indian Army succeeded in breaking the backs of the raiders and securing Srinagar. On 1 January 1948, India put forth its case before the security council of the UN.

